FOR PARENTS ON SCHOOL SITE COUNCIL

Reading your school's plan

Every California school that gets certain state and federal funds writes a School Plan for Student Achievement (SPSA): its yearly roadmap for raising achievement and spending those dollars. The School Site Council, including parents, has to approve it. This worksheet helps you turn a long, technical plan into a one-page summary families can read, and a short list of questions to ask.

1. The plan at a glance

For each goal, write one plain sentence: where things are now, the target, the main strategy, and roughly how much money is attached.

2. Things that don't quite add up

Look for starting numbers that differ in two places, old text copied from past years, goal dates that weren't updated, and budget lines left blank. Frame these as questions, not accusations. Most are leftovers, not cover-ups.

3. An equity read

Which groups of students does the plan name as focal? Did money for those students go up or down from last year? Is it tracked and reported back to the council?

4. Governance check

Is the member roster filled in? Are parent seats vacant? Is there an adoption date, and is the assurances page signed? Are any positions paid for by a grant that ends soon?

5. Questions to put on the record

Start by naming what's working. Then ask. You can move to approve on the condition that missing pieces are filled in.